

Assignment 1 — Video Game Concept Document and Prototype Development

Jay A Career

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1. Game Concept

1.1 Working Title

Jay A Career

1.2 Concept Statement

Jay A Career is a 3D single-player crime-drama simulation and exploration game following Jay, a young man attempting to build a career through an underground fictional business.

Jay works with an experienced technical partner who helps him establish a small operation. Instead of focusing on combat or a large open world, the game focuses on the everyday routine of building the operation.

The player prepares fictional products, organizes the workspace, makes deliveries, communicates with customers, negotiates simple deals, returns to the laboratory, cleans the workspace, and ends the day by sleeping.

The core gameplay loop is:

Prepare → Deliver → Negotiate → Clean → Sleep → Progress

The prototype is intentionally small so that it can demonstrate Unity fundamentals such as GameObjects, Transform manipulation, materials, textures, Prefabs, scene construction and basic interaction.

The fictional product in the game is entirely invented. The game does not reproduce real-world drug recipes, chemical procedures, or instructions.

2. Inspiration and Originality

The main creative inspiration is the atmosphere of modern crime dramas, particularly stories involving partnerships, business development, difficult decisions, desert environments and character-driven tension.

One reference is *Breaking Bad*, whose official AMC material describes the partnership between Walter White and Jesse Pinkman and their progression into the criminal world.

However, *Jay A Career* is an original game concept.

The game will NOT use:

- Walter White
- Jesse Pinkman
- Heisenberg
- Albuquerque as a recreated location
- Breaking Bad logos
- Breaking Bad dialogue
- Breaking Bad scenes
- Breaking Bad character models
- The Breaking Bad laboratory
- Real-world drug recipes
- Real-world chemical production instructions

Instead, the project uses:

- Jay as the original protagonist
- Original supporting characters
- An original desert town
- An original laboratory/workspace
- A fictional product
- Original dialogue
- Original objectives

- Original gameplay systems
- Original scene design

The purpose is to use a crime-drama atmosphere as inspiration while creating an independent game concept.

3. Selecting the Game Genre

3.1 Primary Genre

Simulation

3.2 Secondary Genres

- Adventure
- Narrative
- Crime Drama
- Business Simulation
- Exploration

Simulation games allow players to interact with systems representing activities, environments or management situations. The history of simulation games extends back to early computer games such as *The Sumerian Game* in 1964, while early economic and management simulations were followed by titles such as *M.U.L.E.* and later city-building simulations such as *SimCity*.

The genre has developed from relatively simple management systems into highly interactive 3D simulations involving businesses, vehicles, characters, environments and economic systems.

Jay A Career uses a small-scale version of this concept. Instead of attempting to simulate an entire criminal empire, the prototype focuses on the player's daily activities and decisions.

3.3 Defining Characteristics

The genre commonly involves:

- Managing resources
- Making decisions

- **Completing tasks**
- **Interacting with environments**
- **Progression**
- **Planning**
- **Risk and reward**
- **Repeated gameplay loops**
- **Player-controlled systems**

The proposed game combines these characteristics with exploration and narrative.

3.4 Personal Motivation

I selected simulation and crime-drama games because I am interested in games where the player does more than simply fight enemies.

I want the player to feel that they are gradually building something.

The idea of starting with a small operation and improving it through daily decisions creates a clear sense of progression.

I also selected this genre because it is technically suitable for a Unity student prototype. The environment can be built from relatively simple 3D objects, while interactions can be implemented without requiring advanced artificial intelligence or multiplayer systems.

4. Target Audience

4.1 Primary Audience

The primary target audience is players approximately 18 years old and above who enjoy:

- **Simulation games**
- **Crime dramas**
- **Narrative games**
- **Exploration**

- **Business/progression mechanics**
- **Character-driven stories**
- **Decision-making**
- **Atmospheric environments**

4.2 Player Motivation

Players may be motivated by:

- **Building something from nothing**
- **Seeing progression over time**
- **Exploring environments**
- **Completing objectives**
- **Making decisions**
- **Discovering the story**
- **Improving their fictional business**
- **Experiencing character relationships**

4.3 Play Style

The game is intended for players who prefer:

- **Single-player experiences**
- **Exploration**
- **Slow-to-moderate pacing**
- **Environmental interaction**
- **Storytelling**
- **Management and decision-making**

The game is not designed primarily for competitive players or players looking for combat-focused experience.

5. Competitor Analysis

5.1 Market Presence

Crime and simulation games appear across multiple platforms.

On PC, *Drug Dealer Simulator* is available through Steam and focuses on starting from a small operation and expanding it through deliveries, customers, laboratories, business management and progression. Its Steam page currently reports thousands of English-language reviews with a Very Positive overall rating.

On consoles, *Drug Dealer Simulator* is also available on PlayStation 4 and PlayStation 5.

On mobile, crime/business simulation concepts are also present. For example, *My Criminal Empire* is available on iPhone and iPad as an idle crime simulator/business-management game.

Google Play also contains several crime/business simulation titles, showing that the basic theme is present in the mobile market as well.

This shows that the broader crime-simulation concept exists across PC, console and mobile, although the gameplay scope and presentation differ substantially between platforms.

6. Competitor 1 — Drug Dealer Simulator

Description

Drug Dealer Simulator is a first-person crime simulation game released in 2020. Its Steam description presents a progression from a small hideout toward a larger criminal operation involving deliveries, customers, territory, laboratories, employees and business expansion.

Strengths

The game provides:

- Clear progression
- First-person immersion
- Resource management
- Deliveries

- Customers
- Business expansion
- Multiple environments
- Long-term progression

The Steam page currently reports more than 9,500 English-language reviews and an overall Very Positive English review rating.

Weaknesses / Limitations Relevant to My Concept

The game's larger scope includes systems such as territory, police encounters, rival organizations, laboratories, employees and broader criminal-business management.

For a student prototype, recreating that scale would be impractical.

Therefore, *Jay A Career* deliberately reduces the scale and focuses on:

- One protagonist
- One partner
- A small environment
- A small number of customers
- A short daily gameplay loop
- Simple interactions
- Simple negotiations

7. Competitor 2 — Schedule I

Schedule I was released in March 2025 and is a crime/simulation game involving manufacturing, distribution, customers, properties, employees, driving and business expansion. Its Steam page currently reports more than 200,000 English-language reviews, with 97% positive English reviews shown on the current Steam listing.

Strengths

The game combines:

- Simulation
- Management
- Crafting
- Business expansion
- Open-world exploration
- Driving
- Character interaction
- Single-player and online co-op features

These systems provide a large amount of player freedom and progression.

Difference From Jay A Career

Jay A Career is intentionally much smaller.

It does not attempt to recreate an open-world business simulator.

The prototype concentrates on:

One character → one partner → one workspace → a few customers → a daily routine.

This keeps the scope appropriate for a university prototype.

8. Competitor 3 — Mobile Crime/Business Simulators

The mobile market also contains crime/business simulation games.

For example, *My Criminal Empire* is an iPhone/iPad idle crime simulator involving business management, resources, supply chains, employees and expansion.

Google Play also contains crime-business simulation games with systems involving production, customers, upgrades and expansion.

These examples demonstrate that the broader concept is not limited to PC.

However, mobile examples often emphasize:

- Short sessions

- Idle progression
- Ads
- In-app purchases
- Simplified controls

Jay A Career instead focuses on a small 3D PC environment with direct player movement and environmental interaction.

9. Competitor Challenge Analysis

The major challenges found in competing games include:

Resource Management

Players must manage money, resources, equipment and business growth.

Delivery

Players must travel to customers and complete orders.

Risk

Players may need to make decisions under pressure.

Progression

Players start with a small operation and gradually unlock additional opportunities.

Exploration

Players navigate environments to complete tasks.

Customer Interaction

Players communicate with customers and complete transactions.

Jay A Career uses simplified versions of these challenges.

The prototype does not require complex artificial intelligence or a large economy.

10. Market Gap / Opportunity

The researched competitors demonstrate a strong focus on large-scale systems such as open worlds, territory, production, employees, police systems, crafting and business expansion.

The opportunity for *Jay A Career* is therefore to focus on the smaller human scale.

Instead of asking:

"How do I control an entire criminal empire?"

the game asks:

"How does Jay survive another day and gradually build his career?"

The prototype emphasizes:

- Character relationships
- Daily routine
- Environmental storytelling
- Simple negotiation
- Small-scale exploration
- Workspace interaction
- Day-to-day progression

This provides a smaller and more focused experience suitable for a student prototype.

11. Unique Selling Points

The main selling points are:

1. Daily career progression

The player experiences the protagonist's career one day at a time.

2. Character-driven gameplay

The relationship between Jay and his partner is an important part of the experience.

3. Small-scale simulation

The game focuses on one operation instead of a huge open world.

4. Negotiation

Customers can create simple decisions that affect money and progression.

5. Environmental storytelling

The workspace and surrounding environment communicate information about the characters and their business.

6. Simple but complete gameplay loop

Prepare → Deliver → Negotiate → Clean → Sleep → Progress.

12. One-Line Pitch

Jay A Career is a 3D crime-drama simulation where a young man builds an underground fictional business one day at a time through preparation, deliveries, negotiation, exploration and difficult decisions.

13. Player Experience and POV

The player controls Jay from a third-person or first-person perspective depending on the final Unity implementation.

The intended experience is:

- **Immersive**
- **Atmospheric**
- **Exploratory**
- **Narrative-driven**
- **Relaxed during preparation**
- **More tense during deliveries and negotiations**

The player should feel that the environment is gradually becoming Jay's workplace and that each completed day represents progress in his career.

14. Game World Fiction

The game takes place in a fictional desert town.

The town contains:

- **A small laboratory/workspace**
- **A desert road**
- **A small residential area**
- **Customer locations**
- **Storage areas**
- **Jay's bedroom**
- **Industrial buildings**

The environment uses a combination of:

- **Desert sand**
- **Concrete**
- **Metal**
- **Industrial objects**
- **Old vehicles**
- **Storage containers**
- **Barrels**
- **Crates**
- **Signs**
- **Lighting**

The world is completely fictional and is not a recreation of Albuquerque or any Breaking Bad location.

15. Main Characters

Jay

Jay is the player character.

He is young and ambitious and wants to build a better career for himself.

Dr. Hale

Dr. Hale is Jay's experienced technical partner.

He provides knowledge and guidance but expects Jay to handle customers, deliveries and business decisions.

Customers

Customers provide the main delivery and negotiation objectives.

They are original fictional characters.

16. Core Gameplay Loop

The core loop is:

PREPARE

↓

DELIVER

↓

NEGOTIATE

↓

RETURN

↓

CLEAN

↓

SLEEP

↓

NEXT DAY



PROGRESS

This loop is repeated with progressively more difficult objectives.

17. Gameplay Mechanics

17.1 Preparation

The player begins the day inside the workspace.

The player interacts with a preparation station and completes a simple fictional preparation task.

The system is deliberately abstract.

No real-world chemical procedure is represented.

The player receives a completed fictional product/package and a delivery objective.

17.2 Delivery

The player leaves the workspace and travels to a customer location.

The environment can be intentionally small.

The objective can be displayed through a simple UI:

Objective: Deliver the package to the warehouse.

17.3 Negotiation

When the player reaches the customer, a simple dialogue interface appears.

The customer can provide an offer.

The player can choose:

- **Accept**
- **Counter**
- **Reject**

The result can modify the player's fictional money/progression variable.

18. Cleaning System

After completing the delivery, the player returns to the workspace.

Objects representing the day's work can be left around the environment.

The player interacts with a cleaning/reset station.

This mechanic represents:

- Completing the workday
 - Restoring the workspace
 - Preparing for the next day
-

19. Sleep System

Jay returns to his room.

The player interacts with the bed.

A simple message appears:

"Sleep until morning?"

After confirmation:

- The current day ends.
 - Progress is stored.
 - The day counter increases.
 - The next objective becomes available.
-

20. Objectives and Progression

Day 1

- Meet Dr. Hale
- Enter the workspace

- **Complete the first preparation**
- **Make the first delivery**
- **Complete the first negotiation**
- **Return to the workspace**
- **Clean**
- **Sleep**

Day 2

- **Prepare a larger fictional order**
- **Travel to a new customer**
- **Negotiate a different offer**
- **Return and clean the workspace**
- **Sleep**

Day 3

- **Complete a larger order**
- **Reach a new customer location**
- **Complete a more difficult negotiation**
- **Earn additional fictional money**
- **Complete the day**

Final Prototype Day

- **Complete the final objective**
- **Return to the workspace**
- **Finish the daily cycle**
- **Display the ending message**

The progression is intentionally small because this is a prototype.

The prototype will contain:

- **Player movement**
- **Camera control**
- **Object interaction**
- **Object movement**
- **Object rotation**
- **Dialogue**
- **Dialogue choices**
- **Money/progression variable**
- **Day counter**
- **Scene transitions**
- **Simple saving/progression**
- **Environmental interaction**
- **Prefabs**
- **Materials**
- **Textures**
- **Lighting**

22. Game Objects

The prototype will contain at least 20 different GameObject models or placeholders as required by the assignment.

Planned objects include:

- 1. Player character**
- 2. Partner character**
- 3. Customer character**
- 4. Laboratory/workspace building**

- 5. Laboratory table**
- 6. Beaker**
- 7. Flask**
- 8. Test tube**
- 9. Storage container**
- 10. Metal cabinet**
- 11. Storage shelf**
- 12. Computer**
- 13. Office desk**
- 14. Office chair**
- 15. Laboratory equipment**
- 16. Pipes**
- 17. Ventilation unit**
- 18. Generator**
- 19. Laboratory door**
- 20. Bed**
- 21. Bedroom table**
- 22. Lamp**
- 23. Car**
- 24. Desert road**
- 25. Barrel**
- 26. Wooden crate**
- 27. Dumpster**
- 28. Warehouse door**
- 29. Telephone pole**
- 30. Street light**

The assignment allows individual models to be reused throughout the scene, so the same object can appear multiple times where appropriate.

23. Materials and Textures

The prototype will contain at least 20 distinct materials/textures.

Planned materials include:

1. Concrete wall
2. Dirty concrete
3. Laboratory floor
4. Metal
5. Rusted metal
6. Stainless steel
7. Glass
8. Dark glass
9. Wood
10. Painted wood
11. Plastic
12. Rubber
13. Cardboard
14. Fabric
15. Leather
16. Desert sand
17. Asphalt
18. Gravel
19. Ceramic
20. Emissive/neon material

21. Dirty wall

22. Bedroom carpet

23. Vehicle paint

24. Warning-sign material

The floor will have its own dedicated material/texture to satisfy the assignment's minimum floor requirement.

24. Prefabs

The prototype will use reusable Prefabs for repeated objects.

Planned Prefabs include:

- **Laboratory table**
- **Laboratory chair**
- **Storage shelf**
- **Barrel**
- **Crate**
- **Laboratory equipment**
- **Street light**
- **Desert rock**
- **Door**
- **Customer-location props**

This demonstrates the GameObject management and Prefab workflow required by the assignment.

25. Scenes

The prototype can use the following scenes:

Scene 1 — Opening

Jay meets Dr. Hale.

Scene 2 — Laboratory

Main preparation and cleaning environment.

Scene 3 — Delivery Area

Customer interaction and negotiation.

Scene 4 — Bedroom

Sleep and progression.

Scene 5 — Ending

Final prototype sequence.

26. Controls

W / A / S / D — Movement

Mouse — Camera

E — Interact

Left Mouse Button — Select dialogue option

ESC — Pause

The exact controls may be adjusted during implementation.

27. Visual Style

The visual style will combine:

- **Stylized realism**
- **Low-poly assets where appropriate**
- **Desert environments**
- **Industrial interiors**
- **Warm outdoor lighting**
- **Dark indoor environments**
- **Concrete**
- **Metal**

- **Dust**
- **Fluorescent lighting**
- **Subtle neon/emissive elements**

Unity's Asset Store provides a large collection of 3D characters, environments and props, making this type of prototype feasible with available assets.

28. Audio Style

The audio will focus on atmosphere.

Possible sounds include:

- **Footsteps**
- **Desert wind**
- **Laboratory machinery**
- **Air conditioning**
- **Doors**
- **Car engine**
- **Telephone notifications**
- **Dialogue sounds**
- **Night ambience**
- **Morning ambience**

Music will be limited to important story or negotiation moments.

29. Monetization Strategy

If developed as a complete commercial game, the proposed model would be a premium one-time purchase.

The prototype itself will have no monetization.

A premium model is suitable for the concept because the game is designed around a focused single-player narrative experience rather than an advertisement-driven or free-to-play structure.

30. Platforms, Technology and Scope

Platform

Primary platform: Windows PC

The PC platform is selected because:

- **Unity supports Windows development.**
- **Keyboard and mouse controls are appropriate.**
- **It is suitable for a university prototype.**
- **It allows straightforward testing.**

Technology

The prototype will use:

- **Unity**
- **Universal Render Pipeline**
- **Standard Unity GameObjects**
- **Materials**
- **Textures**
- **Prefabs**
- **Basic Unity UI**
- **C# scripts where necessary**

Unity describes URP as a prebuilt Scriptable Render Pipeline designed to provide optimized graphics across platforms ranging from mobile to high-end PC and consoles.

Scope

The prototype deliberately excludes:

- **Multiplayer**
- **Large open world**
- **Advanced AI**
- **Complex combat**
- **Procedural generation**
- **Complex economy**
- **Real chemistry simulation**
- **Real-world drug production**
- **Advanced police AI**
- **Large-scale inventory systems**

This keeps the project achievable while still demonstrating the required Unity skills.

31. Prototype Connection to the Assignment

The prototype directly demonstrates the practical requirements of the assignment.

The Unity project will demonstrate:

- **A URP project**
- **Scene creation**
- **GameObjects**
- **Transform manipulation**
- **Object movement**
- **Object rotation**
- **Materials**
- **Textures**
- **Floor material**
- **Imported models**

- **Prefabs**
- **Multiple environmental objects**
- **Basic interaction**
- **Basic progression**
- **A playable prototype**

The assignment specifically requires a Unity prototype using URP, excluding Cinemachine, with fundamental interactions, scene setup and Prefab management.

32. Unity Project Structure

The project will use an organized structure:

Assets/

JayACareer/

Scenes/

Materials/

Textures/

Prefabs/

Models/

Scripts/

Audio/

UI/

This structure keeps the project organized and makes the final project easier to inspect.

33. Creativity and Differentiation

The concept is intentionally different from existing crime simulation games.

Existing games such as *Drug Dealer Simulator* and *Schedule I* focus heavily on large-scale criminal-business systems such as open-world environments, expansion, production, employees, territory or large economies.

Jay A Career instead focuses on the smaller human experience of building a career one day at a time.

Its main differentiators are:

- A compact environment
 - A strong daily routine
 - Character-driven progression
 - Simple negotiation
 - Workspace interaction
 - Environmental storytelling
 - A limited prototype scope
 - Original characters and fictional world
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34. Conclusion

Jay A Career is a small-scale 3D crime-drama simulation and exploration game about a young man attempting to build a career through an underground fictional business.

The player experiences the story one day at a time through:

Prepare → Deliver → Negotiate → Clean → Sleep → Progress

The concept is inspired by the atmosphere and partnership-driven storytelling of crime dramas, but it uses original characters, locations, dialogue, fictional products and gameplay.

The project is deliberately designed around Unity fundamentals and can demonstrate GameObjects, Transform manipulation, materials, textures, Prefabs, scene construction and basic interaction.

The limited technical scope allows the prototype to remain achievable while still satisfying the required asset and Unity-development requirements of Assignment 1.

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